

Kotter's 8 Steps

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Leading change without losing people

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

Kotter's 8-Step Process for Leading Change sets out a sequence — from establishing urgency to anchoring change in the culture — for delivering organisational change without the common failure modes.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Developed by John Kotter in *Leading Change* (1996), based on study of corporate change efforts.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

It was developed because most change programmes fail, often for want of urgency or short-term wins, which the steps address.

FIGURE 1 · KOTTER'S 8 STEPS



Figure 1. A schematic of the Kotter's 8 Steps as applied in BARBM312 (illustrative).

HOW IT IS USED

Change is led through the eight steps in sequence, ensuring urgency, coalition, vision, communication, wins and anchoring.

WHEN IT IS USED

During organisational change, including AI-driven transformation and rebranding.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Change leaders, executives and transformation teams.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

It distilled change leadership into a memorable, evidence-based sequence that remains a default playbook.

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Burning Platform vs. Burning Ambition · Slibrary 20

Transition Curve · Slibrary 20

Change Readiness Radar · Slibrary 20

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Kotter, J.P. (1996) *Leading Change*. Boston: HBS Press.

Kotter, J.P. (1995) 'Leading change: Why transformation efforts fail', *Harvard Business Review*, 73(2).